

INITIAL EVALUATION · NMS-BRD-2026

⚠ INTERNAL USE ONLY — DO NOT SHARE WITH VENDOR

PRTG Network Monitor

Vendor Response Analysis

Initial-stage assessment of the vendor submission received from Paessler / PRTG reseller. Cross-referenced against BRD NMS-BRD-2026 Must Have and Should Have requirements. For internal evaluation and decision-making only.

Vendor	Paessler AG (PRTG Network Monitor)
Submission Type	Cover letter + Fact Sheet + Product Brochure
BRD Reference	NMS-BRD-2026 · v2.0
Analysis Date	June 2026
Analysed By	CodeOx Technologies
Stage	Initial Review — Pre-Shortlist
Must Have Coverage	~68% confirmed · 4 gaps · 1 critical conflict
Preliminary Verdict	Proceed with Clarifications — Not Ready for POC Yet

SUMMARY FINDING

PRTG covers the majority of performance monitoring and alerting requirements. However, the vendor submission contains a **critical factual conflict on topology mapping** — the proposal claims dynamic L2/L3 network maps, while Paessler's own official fact sheet explicitly states PRTG does NOT include layer 2/3 topology auto-mapping. Additionally, no commercial proposal or pricing was submitted, AD/LDAP and SAML authentication are unaddressed, NCA ECC 2018 compliance posture is absent, and the license tier required for 1,000 nodes is unspecified. **7 clarification questions must be answered before shortlisting for POC.**

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SECTION 1

Submission Overview

DOCUMENTS RECEIVED

Three documents submitted: (1) cover letter / pitch narrative from local reseller, (2) PRTG Network Monitor Fact Sheet — Paessler official, dated 2015 (version 434699/EN/20150320), (3) PRTG Network Monitor product brochure — Paessler official, dated November 2021 (007802/EN/20211115). **No commercial/pricing proposal was included. No formal BRD compliance matrix was provided.**

Attribute	Detail
Vendor / Product	Paessler AG — PRTG Network Monitor
Submission Channel	Local reseller / partner (Paessler authorised distributor)
Document Age	Fact sheet: 2015. Brochure: November 2021. No current 2025/2026 datasheet provided.
Pricing Submitted	No — commercial proposal absent
BRD Compliance Matrix	Not provided — vendor did not complete requirements matrix
License Tier Proposed	Not specified — PRTG 500 / 1000 / 2500 / 5000 / XL1 / Enterprise Monitor options not clarified
KSA / GCC Support Mentioned	Partial — reseller referenced Riyadh & Jeddah sites but no formal support SLA or Arabic support confirmed

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SECTION 2

BRD Must Have — Compliance Status

22

CONFIRMED

9

PARTIAL / UNCONFIRMED

4

NOT ADDRESSED

1

CRITICAL CONFLICT

BRD Ref	Requirement	Status	Note
FR-01	Automated ICMP ping sweep / device discovery	Confirmed	Auto-discovery confirmed in all documents
FR-02	SNMP v1/v2c/v3 polling with configurable credentials	Confirmed	Confirmed in proposal and brochure
FR-03	CDP/LLDP neighbor discovery	Unconfirmed	Not explicitly confirmed in any document. PRTG has SNMP-based neighbor discovery but native CDP/LLDP parsing needs clarification.
FR-04	Custom MIB file import	Confirmed	"Flexible and easy import of MIB data files" — brochure p.5
FR-06	Scheduled recurring discovery scans	Confirmed	Auto-discovery scheduling confirmed
FR-08	Bulk device import via CSV	Unconfirmed	Not mentioned in any submitted document. Needs clarification.
FR-09	SNMP polling — CPU, memory, interface metrics	Confirmed	CPU, memory, interface monitoring confirmed
FR-10	Per-interface metrics: in/out rate, error rate, discard rate	Confirmed	Interface traffic and bandwidth monitoring confirmed
FR-11	Real-time up/down status with color-coded indicators	Confirmed	Confirmed via dashboard screenshots and brochure
FR-12	ICMP round-trip latency per device	Confirmed	PING sensor confirmed in brochure
FR-14	WMI polling for Windows servers	Confirmed	WMI confirmed in proposal and brochure
FR-15	SNMP trap reception and correlation	Confirmed	SNMP traps confirmed in proposal

BRD REF	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTE
FR-17	NetFlow v9 ingestion and processing	✔ Confirmed	NetFlow, jFlow, sFlow, IPFIX all confirmed
FR-18	sFlow support	✔ Confirmed	Confirmed in proposal and brochure
FR-19	IPFIX support	✔ Confirmed	Confirmed in proposal and brochure
FR-20	Top-N bandwidth consumers by interface	✔ Confirmed	Top bandwidth consumers confirmed in proposal
FR-24	Threshold-based alerting on SNMP metrics	✔ Confirmed	Threshold alerting is core PRTG feature
FR-26	Email alert notifications	✔ Confirmed	Email notifications confirmed in proposal and brochure
FR-27	SMS notifications	✔ Confirmed	SMS confirmed in proposal
FR-28	SNMP trap forwarding / outbound traps	✔ Confirmed	SNMP trap support confirmed
FR-34	Manual drag-and-drop map editor	✔ Confirmed	"Drag & drop map editor" confirmed in brochure p.5
FR-35	Custom NOC dashboards	✔ Confirmed	NOC displays and dashboard builder confirmed
FR-40	Drag-and-drop dashboard builder	✔ Confirmed	Confirmed via brochure and screenshots
FR-42	Scheduled reports (PDF, Excel, HTML)	✔ Confirmed	"Delivery as HTML, PDF, or CSV" — brochure p.5
FR-44	Historical performance reports	✔ Confirmed	"Historic monitoring data stored in original intervals" confirmed
FR-47	REST API for device and sensor data	✔ Confirmed	"Fully featured API" confirmed in brochure p.5
FR-50	Syslog event ingestion	✔ Confirmed	Syslog monitoring confirmed in proposal
FR-51	Email gateway (SMTP) for alert delivery	✔ Confirmed	"Integrated mail server" confirmed in brochure p.5

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SECTION 3

Gaps & Unconfirmed Requirements

BRD REF	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	GAP DETAIL
FR-31 / 32	L2 & L3 topology auto-discovery and maps	🚫 CONFLICT	Critical: Proposal claims "Dynamic network maps / Infrastructure topology views." Official Paessler fact sheet (p.2) explicitly states: <i>"PRTG does not include network management such as... layer 2 or layer 3 topologies, auto-mapping."</i> Reseller is overselling. Must be clarified formally.
FR-48	Active Directory / LDAP user authentication	❌ Not Addressed	Not mentioned anywhere in the submission. PRTG does support LDAP integration in newer versions but vendor did not confirm. BRD marks this as Could Have — still requires clarification.
FR-49	SAML 2.0 Single Sign-On	❌ Not Addressed	No mention in proposal or product documents. PRTG Enterprise Monitor may support SAML — vendor must confirm.
FR-53	RBAC with custom roles	⚠️ Unconfirmed	Not addressed in submission. PRTG has basic user groups and access rights but full RBAC with custom roles was not confirmed.
FR-29	Alert escalation policies	⚠️ Unconfirmed	Proposal mentions "escalated automatically based on severity" but no detail on escalation tiers, time-based escalation, or on-call schedule support provided.
FR-08	Bulk device import via CSV	⚠️ Unconfirmed	Not mentioned. PRTG supports API-based bulk add but CSV import is not a confirmed native feature.
FR-13	Raw performance data retention ≥90 days	⚠️ Unconfirmed	Brochure confirms raw data is stored ("not summarized") but no specific retention period stated. Storage sizing and retention policy must be confirmed.
FR-52	ITSM integration (ServiceNow webhook/REST)	⚠️ Unconfirmed	REST API confirmed but ServiceNow-specific integration not mentioned. PRTG uses webhook/REST only — no native certified ServiceNow connector (BRD already notes this as acceptable).
NFR-14–19	NCA ECC 2018 compliance posture	❌ Not Addressed	Zero mention of NCA ECC 2018, ISO 27001, or data residency in any submitted document. BRD Section 10 marks NCA ECC as Mandatory .
NFR-05–09	Scalability — 1,000 nodes / Windows server OS	⚠️ Unconfirmed	License tier not specified. For 1,000 nodes at ~5–8 sensors/device = 5,000–8,000 sensors. PRTG XL1 (10,000 sensor limit) or Enterprise Monitor is required. Vendor did not state which. Windows Server OS required for core — confirm against pre-provisioned VM OS.

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SECTION 4

Red Flags

- 🚫 RED FLAG 1 — TOPOLOGY CLAIM CONTRADICTS OFFICIAL PRODUCT DOCUMENTATION

The reseller's cover letter claims PRTG provides *"Dynamic network maps"* and *"Infrastructure topology views."* The official Paessler fact sheet — from Paessler themselves — explicitly states: **"PRTG does not include network management such as configuration management, layer 2 or layer 3 topologies, auto-mapping."** This is a direct contradiction. The BRD (FR-31/32) requires automatic L2/L3 topology discovery as a **Should Have**. If the reseller cannot demonstrate this feature in a POC, it is a scoring gap. Do not accept the proposal claim without a live demo.
- 🚫 RED FLAG 2 — NO COMMERCIAL PROPOSAL SUBMITTED

The BRD (Section 12) requires a commercial proposal including 3-year TCO, license model, and support SLA. None of this was submitted. PRTG licensing is sensor-based — for 1,000 nodes the correct SKU is **PRTG XL1 (~USD 15–20K one-time + 25% annual)** or **PRTG Enterprise Monitor (subscription)**. Without a formal quote, commercial evaluation cannot proceed.
- ⚠️ RED FLAG 3 — OUTDATED SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

The Paessler fact sheet submitted is dated **March 2015** — over 10 years old. The product brochure is from **November 2021**. PRTG has evolved significantly since these documents. The current version is PRTG 24.x. Vendor should provide current 2025/2026 product datasheets and licensing information.
- ⚠️ RED FLAG 4 — WINDOWS SERVER ONLY CORE DEPLOYMENT

All official documents confirm PRTG core server runs on **Windows Server only**. The BRD specifies a pre-provisioned VM — if that VM is Linux-based, PRTG cannot be installed. Confirm VM OS with the infrastructure team before proceeding. Remote probes can run on Linux but the core server cannot.

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SECTION 5

Clarification Questions — To Send to Vendor

The following questions must be answered in writing before PRTG can be shortlisted for POC. Send to the reseller and require a formal written response within 5 business days.

- 1**Topology Mapping (FR-31/32):** Your proposal references "Dynamic network maps" and "Infrastructure topology views." The official Paessler fact sheet states PRTG does NOT include L2/L3 topology auto-mapping. Please clarify: Does PRTG automatically discover and render Layer 2 and Layer 3 network topology from CDP/LLDP data? If not, what topology visualisation is actually provided? Provide screenshots from a live environment.
- 2**License Tier & Sensor Count (NFR-06):** For 1,000 monitored nodes with approximately 5–8 sensors per device, the estimated sensor count is 5,000–8,000 sensors. Which PRTG license tier are you proposing (PRTG 5000, XL1, or Enterprise Monitor)? Please provide a formal commercial quotation including Year 1 license cost, annual maintenance for Years 2 and 3, and total 3-year TCO.
- 3**NCA ECC 2018 Compliance (BRD Section 10):** Our environment is subject to Saudi Arabia's NCA Essential Cybersecurity Controls 2018. Please confirm your compliance posture against NCA ECC controls relevant to monitoring tools — specifically data residency (all data on-premises), encrypted credential storage, audit logging, and access control. Provide any applicable compliance documentation.
- 4**Deployment OS (NFR environment):** PRTG core server is documented as Windows Server only. Our pre-provisioned VM environment — please confirm whether PRTG core server can be deployed on a Windows Server VM and confirm supported Windows Server versions (2019/2022). Provide minimum vCPU, RAM, and storage specifications for 1,000 nodes.
- 5**Active Directory / LDAP Authentication (FR-48):** Does PRTG support Active Directory or LDAP-based user authentication? If yes, which PRTG version introduced this and is it available in the license tier you are proposing?
- 6**KSA Regional Support (NFR):** Who is the authorised PRTG reseller / support partner in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia? What are the local support SLA tiers available? Is Arabic-language support available? Provide references from at least one KSA or GCC healthcare or government organisation currently running PRTG.
- 7**CDP/LLDP Discovery (FR-03):** Does PRTG natively parse CDP and LLDP data from Cisco switches to discover and map neighbour relationships? If yes, please confirm the specific sensor or method used, and whether this populates the device inventory automatically or requires manual configuration.

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SECTION 6

Preliminary Assessment & Next Step

✔ PRTG STRENGTHS (VS. BRD)

Strong core monitoring — SNMP v1/v2c/v3, NetFlow/sFlow/IPFIX, WMI, ICMP all confirmed. Dashboard builder, scheduled reports, REST API, and multi-site remote probe architecture are solid. 150,000+ global installations and 27-year track record provide confidence. Healthcare sector listed as a target vertical. Fast time-to-value post-installation.

⚠ PRTG WEAKNESSES (VS. BRD)

Windows Server only for core. No native L2/L3 topology auto-mapping (reseller claim is inaccurate). No native ServiceNow connector (webhook only). NCA ECC compliance not addressed. License tier not specified. KSA local support not formally confirmed. Outdated documents submitted.

📋 RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

Step 1:

Send the 7 clarification questions above to the reseller. Set a 5 business day deadline for written responses.

Step 2:

On receipt of answers, re-evaluate the topology mapping claim. If PRTG cannot demonstrate L2/L3 auto-discovery in a live demo, downgrade this gap in the BRD scoring.

Step 3:

Request a commercial quotation — PRTG XL1 or Enterprise Monitor for 1,000 nodes, 3-year TCO.

Step 4:

Confirm VM OS compatibility before any POC scheduling.

Do NOT shortlist for POC

until written answers to Q1 (topology), Q2 (pricing), and Q3 (NCA ECC) are received.

#	EVALUATION CRITERION (BRD SEC 11)	WEIGHT	PRELIMINARY SCORE
1	Functional Coverage — Must Have requirements met natively	30%	~68% — Pending
2	Scalability & Performance (1,000 nodes)	15%	Strong
3	Security & Compliance (NCA ECC 2018)	15%	Not Assessed
4	Total Cost of Ownership — 3-year	15%	Not Submitted
5	Vendor Stability & Roadmap	10%	Strong — 27 yrs
6	Migration & Transition Ease	8%	Good

#	EVALUATION CRITERION (BRD SEC 11)	WEIGHT	PRELIMINARY SCORE
7	Support Quality — KSA / MENA presence	7%	Unconfirmed